



BRIDAL LINE

PINK IS the colour of the day for brides as they sit in a quiet line waiting for the wedding rituals to begin at a mass marriage ceremony in Ahmedabad. Eighty-one Muslim couples were married at the event on November 8.

BANGALORE | Footing the Bill

Walkers in Lal Bagh are miffed at the authorities' attempts to charge them Rs 200 annually for a walk in the park. Horticulture Department Director N. Jayaram says the fee hike will help step up security for the 3,000 walkers who use the park each year. In April 2009, a 38-year-old real estate agent and financier was hacked to death in front of his mother and sister in the garden when he went for his morning walk. Jayaram says if the walkers don't want to cough up the fee, they must at least agree to his department's plan to issue an ID for every walker. Set up 245 years ago by Mysore warrior Tipu Sultan's father Hyder Ali, the garden is a botanist's delight and home to nearly 2,000 species of plants. The Lal Bagh Rock, one of the oldest rock formations on earth, is believed to be three billion years old. For the park's walkers, green is going red.

by Stephen David



THE AUTHORITIES' EFFORTS TO CHARGE A FEE FOR LAL BAGH'S USAGE HAVE BEEN MET WITH RESISTANCE BY WALKERS.